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Online study on learning and decision-making

CUREC Approval Reference: R96268/RE001

General Information

The aim of this research is to understand how the human brain learns to make adaptive decisions in changing environments.

We appreciate your interest in participating in this online task. You have been invited to participate as you are 18-64 years old, speak English fluently, have normal or corrected-to-normal vision, and do not have a current diagnosis of a neurological or psychiatric condition. Please read through this information before agreeing to participate (if you wish to) by clicking the 'accept' button.

The Principal Researchers are Cédric Foucault and Amy Li, who are attached to the Department of Experimental Psychology at the University of Oxford. This research is being completed under the supervision of Professor Laurence Hunt. You may ask any questions before deciding to take part by contacting the researcher (details below).

If you give consent to participate in this research, you will complete an online study involving 60-90 minutes of completing a computer task. The study will involve making decisions about some visual stimuli. You will be asked to make decisions, like moving an onscreen bar, around to maximise points reward in the task. No background knowledge is required.

The data is needed as part of a study which investigates how humans learn and make decisions in changing environments. The research data (mouse and button presses, and response times) collected during the task is important for helping us characterise how people learn and make decisions. We will also ask for some personal data (age, gender, handedness) as such basic demographics information is required for journal article publication. Both the research and personal data will be stored securely on password-protected computers; anonymous participant code numbers will be used so that the data is de-identified.

Do I have to take part?

No. Please note that participation is voluntary. If you do decide to take part, you may withdraw at any point for any reason before submitting your answers by pressing the 'Exit' button/ closing the browser. However, we are only able to reimburse, and pay out bonus payments to, participants who complete all research activities.

We have included a 'Prefer not to say' option for each set of questions should you prefer not to answer a particular question.

How will my data be used?

The data we will collect that could identify you will be age, gender, and handedness. Your IP address will not be stored. We will take all reasonable measures to ensure that data remain confidential.

The responses you provide will be stored in a password-protected electronic file on University of Oxford secure servers and may be used in academic publications, conference presentations, and theses. Identifiable information will not be collected.

Research data will be stored indefinitely after publication or public release of the work of the research; in order to make our data widely available (and our findings reproducible) after study completion, the de-identified data will be archived on a publicly available online repository

Who will have access to my data?

The University of Oxford is the data controller with respect to your personal data and, as such, will determine how your personal data is used in the research. The University will process your personal data for the purpose of the research outlined above. Research is a task that we perform in the public interest. Further information about your rights with respect to your personal data is available from <https://compliance.admin.ox.ac.uk/individual-rights>.

The researcher and/or research team will have access to the research data. Responsible members of the University of Oxford may be given access to data for monitoring and/or audit of the research.

The research data from this study may be used for other, future research projects in addition to the study you are currently participating in. Those future projects may focus on other research topics, unrelated to the main goals of this study. We may give access to the data we are collecting to the general public via the Internet using a fully open online data repository. Importantly, the data we share with the general public will not have your name on it, only a code number, so people will not know your name or which data are yours.

The results of the research will be written up in academic publications, conference presentations, and a DPhil thesis.

Who has reviewed this research?

This research has been reviewed by, and received ethics clearance through, a subcommittee of the University of Oxford Central University Research Ethics Committee (R96268/RE001).

Who do I contact if I have a concern or I wish to complain?

If you have a concern about any aspect of this research, please contact Cédric Foucault (cedric.foucault@chch.ox.ac.uk), Amy Li (amy.li@psy.ox.ac.uk), or Prof. Laurence Hunt (laurence.hunt@psy.ox.ac.uk; 01865-618346), and we will do our best to answer your query. We will acknowledge your concern within 10 working days and give you an indication of how it will be dealt with. If you remain unhappy or wish to make a formal complaint, please contact the University of Oxford Research Governance, Ethics & Assurance (RGEA) team at rgea.complaints@admin.ox.ac.uk or on 01865 616480.